

Stress
PSY 459 - Fall 2018-2019 (Course #:22358675)
Rowe 205
T/TH 12:30 pm–1:45 pm

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COURSE OVERVIEW

This course defines stress and the underlying biological mechanisms involved, examines methods of measuring stress, evaluates evidence about causes/correlates of stress, and introduces strategies to deal with stress.

Learning Goals

At the end of the course, students should be able to:

1. Recognize definitions and models of stress, sources of stress, and outcomes of stress.
2. Understand the underlying biological mechanisms involved in the stress response.
3. Understand appraisal processes, stress reactions, and ways to manage stress.
4. Apply stress research and theory to the field of psychology as a whole
5. Recognize the limitations of our knowledge and be able to describe desired future directions for research

Required Text

Harrington, R. (2013). Stress, health, & well-being: Thriving in the 21st century. Belmont, CA: Wadsworth Cengage Learning.

Supplementary Text:

Sapolsky, R. (2004). Why Zebras Don't Get Ulcers: Holt Paperbacks (3rd edition).

Class Outline

Various class announcements and materials will be posted on Blackboard throughout the semester. Be sure to check the course schedule for readings and assignments each week.

COURSE REQUIREMENTS

1. Complete all assigned readings prior to class.
2. Engage in the group project.
3. Successfully complete all exams, quizzes, and assignments.

POLICIES

Attendance policy

Students are expected to attend class with full attentiveness. There are no direct punishments for missing a class period. If you are tired, sick, busy, etc., and choose not to attend class, that is your choice. However, some course material will only be available during class.

Email Communication

Most communication outside of class will be done via Blackboard and email. When emailing me please include PSY 459 in the subject line.

Academic Integrity

Work done for this course must adhere to the University Academic Integrity Policy, which you can review in the Undergraduate Bulletin. Most of your assignments need to be submitted online. Submissions will be checked against multiple sources and databases in determining cases of possible plagiarism. This process will be conducted by the system automatically. No credit (0 points) will be assigned if a student is found to be involved in plagiarism. Any individual caught plagiarizing or cheating on exams will receive a grade of 0 and be reported to the Office of Student Affairs and the Psychology Department.

Outside Sources

Several assignments require students to cite the source of their information using APA formatting. This course will consider only three sources to be counted towards the outside source requirement for these assignments: scholarly journals, books/handbooks written by experts in the field, and the course textbooks. Scholarly journals are peer-reviewed periodicals that typically require a subscription to access. Please utilize the CMU library webpage to aid in locating journal articles. Expert books/handbooks require some judgement regarding their relation to relevant stress research. Lastly, use the textbook to your heart's content. All other outside source (ex: popular books, WebMD, Mayo Clinic, Youtube videos, any website, etc.) will not count towards the outside source requirement.

COURSE FORMAT

This class is lecture based, incorporating material from required readings and supplemental information, all of which is fair game on an exam. I will post power point slides on Blackboard by Friday of each week. You are expected to read the chapter assigned for the day before the class. During class time, I may also incorporate discussion questions, videos, and in-class activities.

EVALUATION PROCEDURES

Knowledge of the class material will be assessed by performance on:

1. Exams (100 points each, 400 points total): There will be 4 exams. Exams are multiple choice covering content from required readings, lecture, videos, and other in-class material. No exam is cumulative (including the final exam) but subsequent exams may require your knowledge of previous covered material.

If you know you are going to miss an exam, you must communicate with me well before the exam date so we may re-schedule your exam. This will only be allowed for extenuating circumstances.

2. Quizzes (20 points each, 100 points total): Quizzes will have 10 multiple choice questions covering major concepts and definitions from the textbook to ensure you are keeping up with chapter readings. There are no study guides for quizzes. There will be 7 quizzes. Two of your lowest scoring quizzes will be dropped, meaning that there is a total of 100 points. All quizzes will be given online via blackboard, due dates for quizzes are posted in the course schedule. If a quiz is due that day, it must be submitted on or before 11:59 PM for full credit. Late quizzes will not be accepted but your lowest two quiz scores will be dropped.

3. Group Paper/Presentation (150 points total): You and a team of 3-4 other students will be writing a 5 page paper on a stress-related topic. Four class periods will be devoted to in-class worktime for the project and for the instructor to check on your progress. Groups are expected to present an **outline** of their paper, a **rough draft** and a **final copy** by various due dates outlined in the course schedule. Course time will be devoted for group work and

peer review.

Each group will present their project during a **10-15 minute presentation**. Presentations should be made using PowerPoint or similar presentation software. PowerPoint presentations should be emailed to me before the class period they are presented. Make sure to rehearse your presentation beforehand and ensure that it lasts no longer than 15 minutes. Everyone is expected to attend class during presentations—5% of your project grade will be devoted to presentation attendance. Students are encouraged to ask questions at the end of each presentation.

See the projects instruction form and grading rubric posted on Blackboard for more information. Each individual will be graded according to their individual contribution to the paper/presentation.

Extra Credit Up to 2% (percent not points) extra credit will be available through SONA research participation. For every 1 credit (30 minutes) of SONA participation, students will receive a .25% increase in their grade.

Accommodations

CMU provides individuals with disabilities reasonable accommodations to participate in educational programs, activities and services. Students with disabilities requiring accommodations to participate in class activities or meet course requirements should first register with the office of Student Disability Services (250 Foust hall, telephone 517-774-3018, TDD#2568), and then contact me as early as possible.

GRADING INFORMATION

Your final grade will be based on the amount of points you have accumulated. Grades will be rounded up if they are .5 or higher (ie-89.5=A-) or down if they are below .5 (ie-89.49=B+).

Exams: 400 points (100 points each)

Quizzes: 100 points (20 points each, lowest 2 scores will be dropped)

Project: 150 points:

10 points for outline

20 points for rough draft

70 points for final draft

45 points for presentation

5 points for presentation attendance

TOTAL POSSIBLE POINTS:

650 points

Your letter grade will be determined using the following scale:

93% & above = A

90% - 92% = A-

87% - 89% = B+

83% - 86% = B

80% - 82% = B-

77% - 79% = C+

73% - 76% = C

70% - 72% = C-

67% - 69% = D+

63% - 66% = D

60% - 62% = D-
Below 60% = E

About Blackboard Grades

Grades will be posted to Blackboard as soon as feasible. However, bear in mind that Blackboard is not good at computing overall grades when only some students have a grade for a particular assignment. As such, you are highly encouraged to compute your average independently of Blackboard if you are interested in your progress in the class.

Incompletes

Students must have completed 50% of the coursework with at least a “C” average in order to be eligible to receive an “I.” Incompletes must be finished within two months of the day of the final exam. It is the student’s responsibility to contact the instructor regarding make up assignments.

Recording

In order to protect the intellectual property interests of the instructor, the privacy interests of student members of the class, and to encourage an open and fair exposition of all student views in the classroom without fear that student views expressed will be recorded and possibly posted in another forum, recording of classroom lectures and conversations is not permissible without the express, prior written consent of the instructor. Unauthorized recording of classroom activity shall be considered a violation of the CMU Student Code of Rights, Responsibilities, and Disciplinary Procedures as disruptive of a student’s right to learn under 3.2.3 Disruption of Learning.

Late Assignments

Late assignments will receive a penalty of 20% (two letter grades) EACH DAY that they are late. Assignments will receive zero credit if they are submitted 48 hours after the due date. Assignments are considered late if they are submitted electronically after the dates and times listed in this syllabus, this includes submissions minutes after the due date (ex: 12:05 am when the due date was 11:59 pm).

COURSE SCHEDULE

Lecture Number	Lecture Title	Date	Readings/Materials	Due
1	Syllabus	8/28	Syllabus	
2	Overview of Stress	8/30	Stress, Health and Well-Being CH1	
3	Biology of Stress	9/4	Stress, Health and Well-Being CH3/Zebras CH1	
4	Biology of Stress	9/6	Stress, Health and Well-Being CH4/Zebras CH2	
5	Stress and Health, Illness and the Immune System	9/11	Stress, Health and Well-Being CH5/Zebras CH8	Quiz 1 due
6	Exam 1	9/13		
7	Anxiety, Anger and	9/18	Stress, Health and	

	Depression		Well-Being CH7/Zebras CH14	
8	Anxiety, Anger and Depression	9/20		
9	Emotions and Stress	9/25		Quiz 2 due
10	Interpersonal Stress	9/27	Stress, Health and Well-Being CH8	
11	Job Stress	10/2	Stress, Health and Well-Being CH9	
12	Group Project	10/4		Quiz 3 due
13	Exam 2	10/9		
14	Personality and Stress	10/11	Stress, Health and Well-Being CH6/Zebras CH15	
15	Personality and Stress	10/16		
16	Cognitive and Behavioral Approaches to Stress	10/18	Stress, Health and Well-Being CH10	Quiz 4 due
17	Cognitive and Behavioral Approaches to Stress	10/23		
18	Group Project	10/25		Quiz 5/Paper Outline Due
19	Biology of Stress (advanced)	10/30		
20	Biology of Stress (advanced)	11/1		
21	Exam 3	11/6		
22	Group Project	11/8		Quiz 6 due
23	Psychometrics/Measurement	11/13	Handout	
24	Psychometrics/Measurement	11/15	Handout	Paper Rough Draft Due
25	Stress Management	11/20	Stress, Health and Well-Being CH15	
26	Stress Management	11/27		
27	Group Project	11/29		Quiz 7 due
28	Presentations	12/4		
29	Presentations	12/6		
30	Final Exam (non-cumulative)			Final Paper Due